



UNIVERSITY OF KELANIYA – SRI LANKA
FACULTY OF SCIENCE
Bachelor of Science Honours in Software Engineering Degree
Academic Year 2024/2025 – Semester II

SENG 22223 – Human-Computer Interaction
Assignment 01: What Is HCI, In Your Own Terms?

Bring your answers to the next lecture

Before we define Human-Computer Interaction formally, this warm-up asks you to notice interaction as it already happens around you, as the human, as the device, as a critical observer, and as different people with different reactions. There is no single correct answer here. Rough sketches, arrows, and short notes are perfectly fine. This is about honest observation. We will build our working definition of HCI in class directly from what you bring.

Complete all four tasks below on paper or digitally, and bring your answers to the next lecture. Be ready to share and discuss.

Task 1 : You, the Human — Interacting With Your Smartphone

Think of one everyday interaction you have with your smartphone (e.g., unlocking it, replying to a message, taking a photo). Draw a simple diagram, a flow, a loop, or a labelled sketch showing this interaction from YOUR side, as the human. Then, in around 50 words, describe: what you wanted, what you did, what you saw or felt, and how you knew whether it worked.

Task 2 : Your Smartphone's Side — How It "Sees" You

Now flip the same interaction from Task 1 around. Draw a diagram showing it from the SMARTPHONE'S side instead: what does it sense or detect about you, how might it process that input, and what does it decide to show or do in response? In around 50 words, explain how the device "understood" or perhaps misunderstood you.

Task 3 : Evaluate a Messy Interaction — The Poster

Look closely at the poster below. Treat it as an interface: a viewer must "interact" with it to extract information such as the date, location, contact details, and rules of the event. Evaluate it as you would evaluate a user interface:

- What is the poster trying to communicate, and to whom?
- Identify at least things that make it easy/hard to read or use as an interface
- Suggest specific, concrete changes that would most improve the interaction.



Figure: First Annual "Pennington" Hamfest poster (Princeton, KY)

Task 4 : Compare Two Famous Artworks

For each artwork, briefly note what you feel or think when you look at it. (which one do you prefer and why)



- Bring your answers (handwritten, sketched, or digital) to the next lecture (no need to type these up formally)
- This is ungraded, but come prepared: we will open the lecture by discussing what you noticed, and build our formal definition of HCI from your answers.
- There are no wrong answers here. Only honest ones.

--- End of the assignment ---